DSEH004 · PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT

The Lifecycle and Wellbeing

Week 8 · Lecture 2 · Socialization, the unfolding model, embeddedness and theories of wellbeing

R K Singh

Senior Professor, Department of Commerce, Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi

L2 · THE LIFECYCLE AND WELLBEING

A lifecycle is a sequence of theories, not a journey map

L2 · COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

Sales has the highest burnout in the firm (40.2%) and the lowest voluntary turnover (8.2%). Why do people stay while burning?

Write one theory name on a slip. We will test your choice against three rivals.

Socialization theory: tactics shape the newcomer

Van Maanen and Schein (1979)	Institutionalized pole	Individualized pole
Context	Collective, formal	Individual, informal
Content	Sequential, fixed timetable	Random, variable timetable
Social	Serial (role model), investiture	Disjunctive (no model), divestiture

Jones (1986): institutionalized tactics reduce role ambiguity and produce custodial orientations; individualized tactics produce innovative ones.

Van Maanen and Schein (1979), Research in Organizational Behavior, 1, 209 to 264; Jones (1986), Academy of Management Journal, 29(2), 262 to 279

Newcomer adjustment: three proximal outcomes

Role clarity

Knowing what is expected and how performance is judged

Self efficacy

Confidence in one's ability to do the job

Social acceptance

Feeling liked, trusted and included by insiders

These mediate between socialization and distal outcomes: performance, satisfaction, commitment, intention to remain. Each is delivered mainly by the manager.

The unfolding model: most exits begin with a shock

Path	Shock?	Process
1	Yes	Shock triggers a script already in mind; leave without weighing alternatives
2	Yes	Shock violates one's image of self or values; leave, often without another job
3	Yes	Shock prompts a search; leave for a better alternative
4	No	Satisfaction erodes gradually; leave with or without searching

An annual engagement survey can see only path 4. Paths 1 to 3 start at a moment.

Lee, T. W., and Mitchell, T. R. (1994). An alternative approach: The unfolding model of voluntary employee turnover. Academy of Management Review, 19(1), 51 to 89

Job embeddedness: the forces that hold people

	Organization	Community
Links	Ties to colleagues, teams, clients	Family, friends, local institutions
Fit	Match with job, culture, career plans	Match with place, way of life
Sacrifice	What is lost by leaving: pay, perks, standing	What is lost by relocating

Embeddedness predicts staying beyond satisfaction and commitment. People can stay without being engaged.

Four theories of the Sales paradox

Theory	Why burned out Sales staff stay	Evidence that would favor it
Job demands and resources	They stay, but disengage; exit lags exhaustion	Rising cynicism and falling effort before exits
Self determination	Autonomy is high, so the need for it holds them	Stayers report high autonomy, low competence
Psychological contract	A transactional deal: pay for strain, knowingly	Stayers frame the job as an exchange, not a relationship
Job embeddedness	Sacrifice and community links outweigh strain	Stayers would lose commissions or local ties by leaving

Bakker and Demerouti (2017); Deci and Ryan (2008); Rousseau (1995); Mitchell et al. (2001)

Two traditions, and Warr's vitamin model

Hedonic

Pleasure, satisfaction, the absence of distress

Feeling good

Eudaimonic

Meaning, growth, realizing one's potential

Functioning well

Warr (1987)

Job features act like vitamins: some help up to a point, then harm in excess

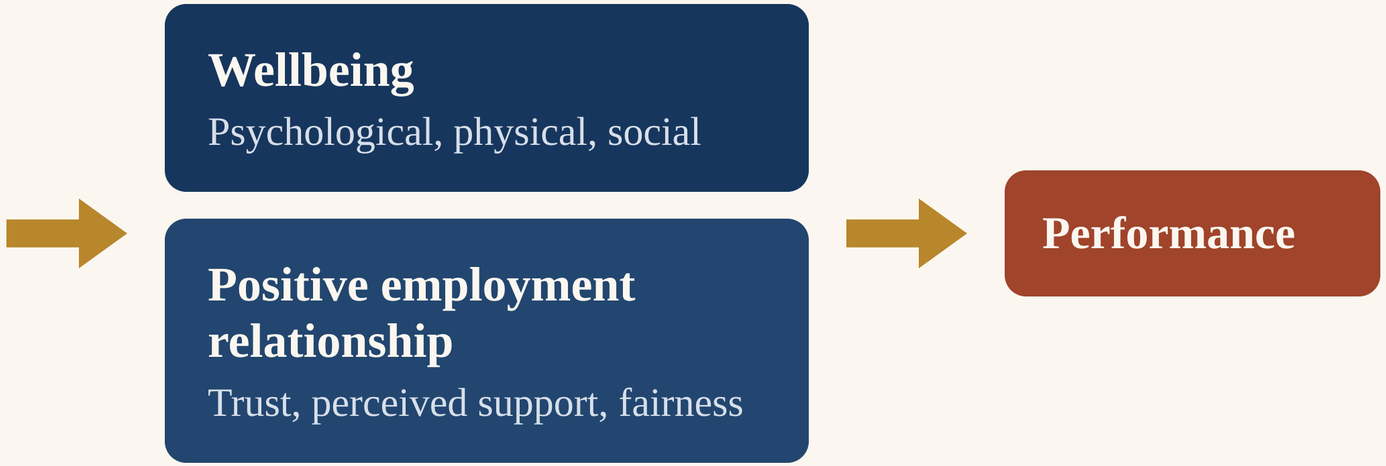
More is not always better

Control, variety and contact help, then harm when excessive. Pay, physical security and status keep a constant effect.

Ryan and Deci (2001), Annual Review of Psychology, 52, 141 to 166; Warr (1987), Work, Unemployment, and Mental Health, Oxford University Press

Guest (2017): wellbeing at the center of HRM

- **Investing in employees**
- **Engaging work**
- **Positive social and physical environment**
- **Voice**
- **Organizational support**



L2 · THE CENTRAL DEBATE

Mutual gains or conflicting outcomes?

Mutual gains

Good HR practice raises performance and wellbeing together, through commitment and reciprocity.

Social exchange logic

Conflicting outcomes

Practices raise performance by intensifying work; wellbeing pays the price.

Labor process critique

Van De Voorde et al. (2012): happiness and relationship wellbeing fit mutual gains; health wellbeing fits conflicting outcomes.

Peccei and Van De Voorde (2019): across 46 studies, mutual gains dominates how research is framed; rival models are rarely tested.

Van De Voorde, Paauwe and Van Veldhoven (2012), International Journal of Management Reviews, 14(4), 391 to 407; Peccei and Van De Voorde (2019), Human Resource Management Journal, 29(4)

Conservation of resources and recovery

Conservation of resources

People strive to obtain and protect resources. Loss weighs more than equal gain.

Those with fewer resources lose more and invest defensively: loss spirals.

Hobfoll (1989)

Recovery experiences

Psychological detachment, relaxation, mastery, control over leisure.

Strain becomes burnout when recovery fails, not when effort is high.

Sonnentag and Fritz (2007)

A wellbeing program adds a resource. If demands keep draining faster, the spiral continues.

Hobfoll (1989), American Psychologist, 44(3), 513 to 524; Sonnentag and Fritz (2007), Journal of Occupational Health Psychology, 12(3), 204 to 221

Which performance system features act on which mechanism

Design choice	Mechanism	Likely wellbeing effect
Stretch targets with no added resources	Demand rises (JD R); loss (COR)	Health wellbeing falls
Frequent coaching check ins	Support and clarity rise	Happiness and relationship wellbeing rise
Forced ranking and stack rating	Threat of loss; justice concerns	Health and relationship wellbeing fall
Specific, timely recognition	Resource gain; distributive justice	Happiness wellbeing rises
Always on feedback apps	Detachment blocked	Recovery fails

Synthesis of Bakker and Demerouti (2017), Hobfoll (1989), Sonnentag and Fritz (2007), Guest (2017), Van De Voorde et al. (2012)

L2 · CLOSE

The Sales burnout split is a design result. Which design choices produced it, and which theory names each mechanism?

One sentence per choice, one theory per sentence.

REFERENCES

Sources for this lecture (1 of 3)

Bakker, A. B., and Demerouti, E. (2017). Job demands resources theory: Taking stock and looking forward. Journal of Occupational Health Psychology, 22(3), 273 to 285.

Bauer, T. N., Bodner, T., Erdogan, B., Truxillo, D. M., and Tucker, J. S. (2007). Newcomer adjustment during organizational socialization: A meta analytic review. Journal of Applied Psychology, 92(3), 707 to 721.

Deci, E. L., and Ryan, R. M. (2008). Self determination theory: A macrotheory of human motivation, development, and health. Canadian Psychology, 49(3), 182 to 185.

Guest, D. E. (2017). Human resource management and employee well being: Towards a new analytic framework. Human Resource Management Journal, 27(1), 22 to 38.

Hobfoll, S. E. (1989). Conservation of resources: A new attempt at conceptualizing stress. American Psychologist, 44(3), 513 to 524.

REFERENCES

Sources for this lecture (2 of 3)

Jones, G. R. (1986). Socialization tactics, self efficacy, and newcomers' adjustments to organizations. Academy of Management Journal, 29(2), 262 to 279.

Lee, T. W., and Mitchell, T. R. (1994). An alternative approach: The unfolding model of voluntary employee turnover. Academy of Management Review, 19(1), 51 to 89.

Mitchell, T. R., Holtom, B. C., Lee, T. W., Sablynski, C. J., and Erez, M. (2001). Why people stay: Using job embeddedness to predict voluntary turnover. Academy of Management Journal, 44(6), 1102 to 1121.

Peccei, R., and Van De Voorde, K. (2019). Human resource management, well being and performance research revisited: Past, present, and future. Human Resource Management Journal, 29(4), 539 to 563.

Rousseau, D. M. (1995). Psychological Contracts in Organizations. Sage.

REFERENCES

Sources for this lecture (3 of 3)

Ryan, R. M., and Deci, E. L. (2001). On happiness and human potentials: A review of research on hedonic and eudaimonic well being. Annual Review of Psychology, 52, 141 to 166.

Sonnentag, S., and Fritz, C. (2007). The Recovery Experience Questionnaire: Development and validation of a measure for assessing recuperation and unwinding from work. Journal of Occupational Health Psychology, 12(3), 204 to 221.

Van De Voorde, K., Paauwe, J., and Van Veldhoven, M. (2012). Employee well being and the HRM and organizational performance relationship: A review of quantitative studies. International Journal of Management Reviews, 14(4), 391 to 407.

Van Maanen, J., and Schein, E. H. (1979). Toward a theory of organizational socialization. Research in Organizational Behavior, 1, 209 to 264.

Warr, P. (1987). Work, Unemployment, and Mental Health. Oxford University Press.